

WebCam-Control-Center 5.5

A Web cam controller

This software controls different elements of a Web cam such as adjusting the brightness, contrast, hue, etc. The software is plain and simple. You can select from 10 different compression modes including formats such as DivX Codec 4.12, Cinepak Codec by Radius and so on.

You can select from the different resolutions offered, ranging from 160x120 to 640x480. The software even has a motion detection facility built-in, which lets you use your camera as a security camera when you're away. It lets you select the sensitivity of motion when it starts recording and even select the



area within the frame. The software lets you take pictures from its own interface without having to click the shutter button on the camera.

SPECIFICATIONS:
3.15 MB install size, Win 98SE/Me/2000, supports resolutions up to 640x480 pixels

Price: \$29.95 (approx Rs 1,438)
Web site:
www.webcam-control-center.com

Webcam-Control-Center B	
Performance	★ ★ ★
Ease of use	★ ★ ★ ★
Value for Money	★ ★ ★ ★
Features	★ ★ ★
OVERALL	★ ★ ★

Maxtor D540X 160 GB Hard Drive

The biggest of 'em all

This hard disk is currently the largest available in India. It has four platters aggregating 160 GB. You will need to buy an additional Ultra ATA/133 IDE PCI controller card because most motherboard BIOSs don't detect a drive larger than 130 GB. The drive can only be detected using the proprietary application (MaxBlast Plus) bundled with it.

With Windows 2000 Professional, its performance matched that of similar speed drives available at a lower capacity. It logged a low CPU



utilisation of 2.04 per cent in SiSoft Sandra Professional. Its average access time of 8 ms was almost on par with most other 5,400-rpm drives. With a rupee to MB ratio of 10 paisa per MB, this drive is a steal.

SPECIFICATIONS:
160 GB capacity, Ultra ATA/133 interface, 2 MB cache, 5400-rpm rotational speed, four platters
Benchmarks: 5500 in High-end Disk Winmark 99; 34 MBps sequential read; 6 MBps random read; 29332 Kbps sequential read speed and 2543.8 Kbps sequential write speed in HDtach; 0.95 per cent CPU Utilisation (Iometer); 124.91 total I/O per second

Price: Rs 18,500 + tax
Contact: Karma Distributors
Phone: 011-6420450
E-mail: naresh@esysmail.com
Web site: www.karmasg.com

Maxtor D540X 160 GB B+	
Performance	★ ★ ★
Build Quality	★ ★ ★ ★
Value for Money	★ ★ ★ ★ 1/2
Features	★ ★ ★
OVERALL	★ ★ ★ 1/2

The Sleuthhound! Pro 3.2

Top dog

Sleuthhound! Pro is a search engine plugin for the desktop that can search anything on the local hard drive, like the Windows search engine.

You just need to type in a keyword from any document present on your hard drive. Sleuthhound! will display all documents with links to the documents and a preview (first four lines). Boolean operations like AND, OR and NOT work with Sleuthhound!. You have to remember to create search zones. This means assigning relevant folders or partitions as a particular zone and naming them accordingly in order

to speed up the process of finding files. You can even search the Web by right-clicking on the main window, which launches

the Sleuthhound! Web page where subcategories such as MP3 search and image search engines are available.

The program doesn't take up much disk space and isn't too heavy on the system either. But it comes at a price of \$79.95.

SPECIFICATIONS:
5.6 MB install size; Boolean search supported; schedule feature built-in for zone update

Price: \$79.95 (approx Rs 3,838)
Web site: www.isleuthhound.com

The Sleuthhound! Pro B+	
Performance	★ ★ ★ 1/2
Ease of use	★ ★ ★ ★
Value for Money	★ ★ ★
Features	★ ★ ★
OVERALL	★ ★ ★ 1/2

PowerARCHIVER v7.02

More power to the archives

PowerArchiver's archiving utility reads most file formats such as ACE, RAR, Zip, TAR, etc. It has a simple skinnable interface. We tested it using a 1.89 MB folder containing Excel files. The folder was compressed to 1.2 MB—a compression efficiency of around 30 per cent. The best part is that the file can be saved as a Zip, CB, LHA, TAR or BH. We saved the file in the Zip format and got the above-mentioned results. PowerArchiver also inherently uses the anti-virus loaded on the system to check for viruses (this has to be defined by giving the correct path for



the anti-virus during installation). This archiver also lets you perform smaller tasks such as renaming and deleting files from within the application itself.

SPECIFICATIONS:
Supports most compression formats, has a skinnable toolbar, has complete integration with Windows

Price: \$19.95 (one license) (approx Rs 958)
Web site: www.powerarchiver.com

PowerARCHIVER B	
Performance	★ ★ ★
Ease of use	★ ★ ★ ★ 1/2
Value for Money	★ ★ ★
Features	★ ★ ★
OVERALL	★ ★ ★